

SOUND MOUND MANUAL

July 2024 Edition

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SOUND MOUND

RESOURCE EXPLANATION

The Sound Mound explanation guide was written to guide you through the phonemes that each Sound Mound references. Within the English Language, there are a lot of words that derive from other languages which make our language difficult to learn, especially for young learners. The goal that I had in mind when creating this resource was to inform educators, parents, guardians, and students on the rules, tips, tricks, and whys of our language, all while providing a visual for students to reference.

Sound Mounds are phonics visuals that allow students to see where certain graphemes are located within the beginning, middle, and ending of words based on the placement of their sound.

This resource is organized by category of graphemes. Each page is labeled with the phoneme that is being targeted. You will find the graphemes correspond to the differentiated Sound Mounds. There are word lists under each phoneme for each grapheme that is being practiced. You can use these guides for dictation activities, phonemic awareness activities, or for decoding activities for students.

If there is a rule that pertains to that certain grapheme-phoneme correspondence, it is written within this resource. It is important to understand that not all graphemes have a rule that can be applied when teaching students the targeted skill.

When using the Sound Mounds, it is important to have students apply sound mapping of the sounds that students hear within words. This in turn will promote the skill of orthographic mapping, which is a mental process that CANNOT be taught to a child. The process of mapping words helps students to permanently retain certain spellings of words.

It is also important to practice these skills by decoding them within text. Click [HERE](#) for the link to the decodable sentences to promote fluency! These align with the Sound Mounds.

WHAT ARE SOUND MOUNDS?

Sound Mounds are phonics visuals that help students see where we hear certain graphemes within the beginning, middle, and ending parts of words or syllables.

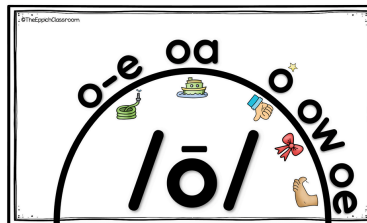
What are phonemes?

Phonemes are units of sounds that we hear within words.

What are graphemes?

Graphemes are letters or combinations of letters that represent a phoneme. There can be more than one grapheme that represents the same phoneme.

Sound Mounds show graphemes in order of frequency within words. For example, if there is more than one grapheme that represents the phoneme, the graphemes will go in order from most common to least common per position of the grapheme (beginning, middle, end). See the example below with the long o. There are more than one way that each phoneme is represented within middle and ending parts, and they are in order based on frequency of the graphemes.



Sound Mounds are differentiated to match the progression of phonics skill that would be taught to students starting in Kindergarten and increasing by grade level. The Sound Mounds are easy to differentiate and are helpful to students who are not ready to progress to grade level skills yet.

It is important to keep in mind that Sound Mounds represent words and syllables. When using the Sound Mounds, words with two or more syllables can also be encoded using the visual. It is always important to count syllables when starting the process of encoding a word. Even if the word is one syllable, it is important to have students become conditioned to counting syllables to produce fluent readers and writers.

HOW TO USE SOUND MOUNDS

To begin, find the Sound Mound that matches the phoneme that you are targeting and the graphemes to match. For example- If you are teaching new graphemes ai and ay, you will use the Sound Mound that meets that level.

The basic procedure to using the Sound Mound would look like this:

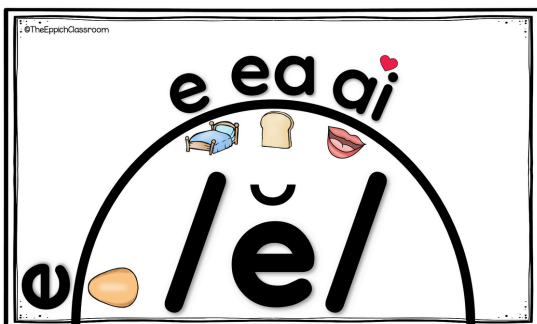
1. Introduce Sound Mounds w/ Phonics Program (SOUND CARDS CAN BE FOUND [HERE](#))
2. Introduce New Graphemes
3. Show Graphemes on the Sound Mound
4. Sort Pictures Showing the position of Graphemes (CLICK [HERE](#) FOR SOUND SORTS)
5. Practice Encoding & Decoding Words
 - a. You will use the word list within this manual to help you dictate words to students. (CLICK [HERE](#) FOR DIGITAL POPIT ACTIVITIES)
 - b. Students should have decodable text available to them to practice the skills that have been introduced.

What does the symbol mean?



On certain Sound Mound cards, you will see a heart or a star. These symbols are visuals to help students with specific patterns.

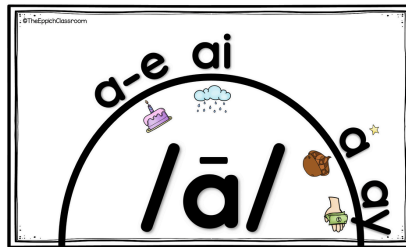
The heart  is a visual to help students with words that contain a heart part. A word with a heart part can be a grapheme that has not been introduced yet or a trick grapheme that is irregular. The heart part of a word can be modeled by first mapping out the phonemes of the word, and then heart the trick part of the word with a heart above grapheme. For example, the word said is a trick word where the ai makes the short E sound. This Sound Mound can be helpful for teaching this trick word.



s ai d

HOW TO USE SOUND MOUNDS

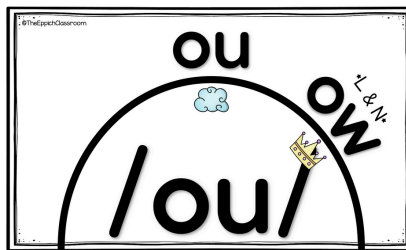
The star ★ symbol represents the patterns that are used in multi-syllable words. You will see this symbol most frequently above open syllable vowels. You can read more about each open syllable in the long vowel section. The graphemes that represents open syllables are typically the most frequent grapheme representing the long vowel in our language in words with more than one syllable. When you are writing words with more than one syllable and that syllable ends with a long vowel, it will more than likely be an open syllable vowel.



For example, the word baby is broken up into two syllables. The syllables are ba/by. When mapping out the word, the star shows students since there is more than one syllable in the word, that is the most common way we see the long a represented within a multi-syllable word.

Beginning Sounds:

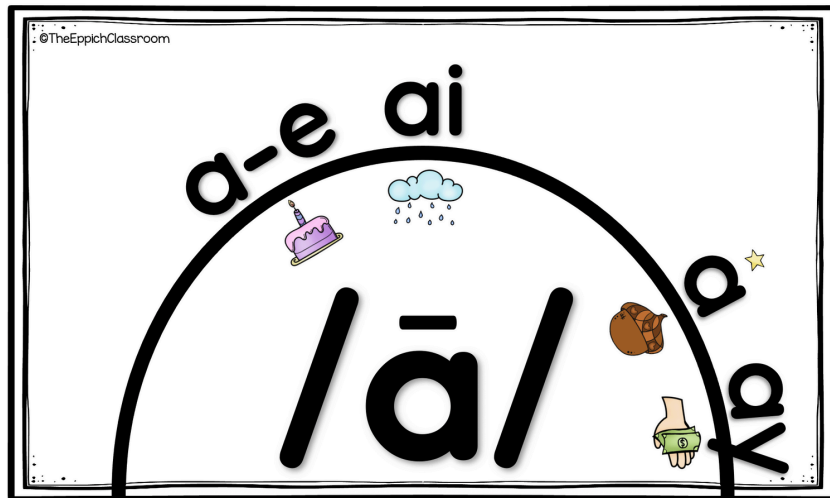
When teaching with the Sound Mounds, there will be times when there is not beginning sound shown to represent a grapheme. If we look at the /ou/ Sound Mound, we see the ou in the middle of the Sound Mound.



If we look at the word ouch, we hear the /ou/ at the beginning of the word. Since there is not beginning sound, you would shift to the next sound that you would see on the Sound Mound- this /ou/ would be represented by the ou grapheme. This would only change if the /l/ or /n/ is heard at the end of the word. As always, it is important to map the words and talk about correct spelling.

Keep in mind Sound Mounds are NOT a one size fits all aid, but instead, are for where we typically hear sounds within words.

USING A SOUND MOUND WITH STUDENTS



Follow These Steps

1. Say It: Say the word orally
2. Hum It: Count the syllables in the word
3. Tap It: Tap out the sound in the word or in each syllable
4. Map It: Map out the sounds in the word or in each syllable
5. Spell It: Using the Sound Mounds, write the graphemes that represent each phoneme within the word. *Use the reference sheets for tips & tricks*

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Say It	Hum It	Tap It	Map It	Spell It
	 1 Syllable	 3 Sounds	— — —	<u>c</u> <u>a</u> <u>ve</u>
	 1 Syllable	 3 Sounds	— — —	<u>m</u> <u>ai</u> <u>l</u>
	 2 Syllables	 2 Sounds/Syllable		<u>b</u> <u>a</u> <u>b</u> <u>y</u>
	 1 Syllable	 2 Sounds	— —	<u>r</u> <u>ay</u>

SHORT VOWELS

Short A

Articulation: Open your mouth wide and keep your tongue low in the mouth when making the short a sound.

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a - middle	cat	bat	mat	rat	sad	had	mad
	dad	bad	rag	bag	wag	fan	pan
	cab	pad	jab	gap	nap	Sam	van
	can	ham	jam	lap	cap	tap	pat
a - beginning	apple	ant	acrobat	ankle	athlete		
	admire	asteroid	anchor	alligator	avocado		
		astronaut	abacus	alphabet			

Tips

- * The short A sound is found within the beginning and middle sounds of words or syllables. The short A is not found at the end of words, because when a is at the end of the word it will produce the schwa sound.
- * When the short A blends with m or n (nasal sounds) the short A can become distorted. Be sure to focus on mouth articulation and blending sounds.
- * When the short A comes after a /w/, it often produces the /ō/ sound due to the change in mouth articulation.

Short E

Articulation: The jaw/chin drops slightly, the mouth forms into a relaxed oval, and the middle of the tongue raises slightly.

e - middle

bed	jet	net	wet	leg	den	men
ten	beg	hen	pet	vet	met	set
gem	pen	web	red	fed	led	let
get	yet	bet	fell	bell	tell	yell

e - beginning

egg	echo	end	edge	elm
ever	else	elf	extra	exit
	every	ever	enter	

ea

head	bread	deaf	wealth	feather
treasure	weather	instead	health	wealthy
death	dread	spread	heavy	breakfast

Short E

Tips

There are no particular tips when teaching the ea grapheme. The variation of ea comes from the evolution of the English language through the Great Vowel Shift. In Middle English, the ea represented the long e sound to be able to differentiate homophones that contained e-e making the long e sound. Now, it stands as an irregular grapheme producing the short e sound.

You will notice a lot of the words that contain ea end with /d/ or /th/.

The best way to help learn these words is for students to map out the sounds within the words and then map the word. On the Sound Mound cards, there is a heart showing the short ea being an irregular phoneme. Students can hear this part to help with their sound mapping.

Also, The short E can sometimes be mistaken for the short I sound. Mouth articulation is important when teaching these sounds. You can use this rhyme to help: /e/ makes me drop my chin, /i/ makes me grin.

Also, the word said can be a trick word within the short e. The ai in said used to be pronounced with the long a sound, but when the vowel transition happened it was not carried over. The word said can be taught as a heart part. The Sound Mound references this as well.

Short I

Articulation: The teeth close together in a smile shape and the sound is pushed from the back of the mouth.

i - middle	pig	pin	sit	lid	win	kit	tip
	lip	dig	rip	sin	tin	six	mix
	fix	wig	kid	bit	dip	rib	zip
	hint	tint	mint	will	pill	bill	mill
i - beginning	itch	it	if	in	is		
	inch	ill	iguana	itchy	inside		
	inflate	inkling	igloo	invite	ink		

Tips

*The short I sound is found within the beginning and middle sounds of words or syllables. The short I can sometimes be mistaken for the short e sound. Mouth articulation is important when teaching these sounds. You can use the rhyme: /e/ makes me drop my chin, /i/ makes me grin.

* When the short I blends with m or n (nasal sounds) the short I can become distorted. Be sure to focus on mouth articulation and blending sounds.

Short O

Articulation: The lips are rounded and pushed forward slightly, tongue in the middle of the mouth.

o - middle	dog	frog	hot	box	pot	top	hop
	Rob	cob	job	fog	log	dot	rod
	pod	mom	Tom	got	sock	dock	shock
	mop	bond	fond	flock	rock	lock	mop
o - beginning	on	olive	otter	off	ostrich		
	office	ox	opposite	odd	object		
	October	often	octopus	onto	offer		

Tips

*The short O Sound can be found at the beginning and middle of words. When the O is at the end of a word, it typically makes the long sound.

*The letter A can make the short o sounds in words like father. Often times this is called the whiny a. This sound has changed over time, but the spelling has not. This can become a heart part for your students. (Ex. quad, squat, swab, swap, watch, etc.)

Short U

Articulation: Mouth open slightly, the back of the tongue pulls up and towards throat.

u - middle	hug bug fun run cup nut sun mud gum cut sud jug pup rug bun hum bus hut cup sum lunch crunch such punt gut pull mulch clutch
u - beginning	up under us umbrella ugly uncle umpire undo upset upon usher udder underpants
ou	touch young double trouble country cousin rough tough enough southern

Short U

o - schwa

love	glove	oven	some	son
done	come	month	wonder	among
cover	dozen	brother	other	govern

Tips

* The ou making the short O sound is a derivation from the Greek language. The spellings of these words changed within the Middle English age. The best way to help students teach these words is to promote sound mapping of words. You can teach these words as an irregular vowel pattern, and hear the tricky part.

* The letter O can also make the short U sound, representing the schwa. A lot of these words are high frequency words that students will need to map out and hear the word. The reasoning that these words make the schwa is because historically speaking these words were made easier to pronounce. The schwa is an unstressed syllable within words that makes the short U sound.

Schwa

Articulation: The tongue, lips, and jaw are relaxed for this unstressed sound.

o

love

glove

oven

some

son

done

come

month

wonder

among

cover

dozen

brother

other

govern

ə

the

camel

item

pollen

problem

children

calendar

silent

elephant

system

blanket

algebra

kitchen

nickel

even

ɒ

was

banana

ago

amount

alone

zebra

idea

balloon

about

comma

lava

magazine

atlas

awake

across

Schwa

—	accident	cousin	difficult	president	family
	ribbon	festival	decimal	promise	pencil

Tips

- * The schwa is an unstressed syllable that makes a neutral vowel sound (or the lazy vowel sound).
- * It is the MOST common vowel in the English language.
- * When a is at the end of a word or syllable, it will produce the schwa sound.
- * Y can also make the schwa sound in certain occasions. It is not common, but can happen within some words. (ex. Pennsylvania, syringe, vinyl, etc.)
- * It is incredibly important to map out sounds within words to identify the schwa sound. The schwa will explain the irregular sounds that are made within words that do not match the normal short vowel sound. HOWEVER, it is important to teach students that the schwa IS a regular, and important, vowel sound in our language.

Short oo

Articulation: The lips pursed and rounded, tongue in the middle of the mouth.

oo

book

cook

look

hook

took

wood

good

hood

foot

brook

shook

rookie

crook

Tips

* The grapheme oo represents the short /oo/ sound. When the grapheme oo is followed by an l or r, which are liquid sounds, the oo phoneme becomes distorted.

EX: Words with r proceeding the oo:

- poor
- door
- moor

Words with l proceeding the oo:

- pool
- wool

*The words could, should, and would are heart p within the oo family. In this case the oul makes the /oo/ sound.

LONG VOWELS

Long A

Articulation: Mouth is open wide, push air from mouth, and tongue is low and toward the back of your mouth.

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a-e	gate	fate	plate	race	case	face	made
	make	rake	cake	shake	Blake	take	lake
	wave	tame	mane	flake	trade	stage	trade
	space	wave	same	came	update	rotate	estate
a - open syllable	apron	acorn	agent	April	paper	bacon	favor
	baby	fatal	lady	basic	halo	radio	table
	able	angel	data	labor	radar	potato	vacant
	maple	naval	crazy	lazy	cable	tomato	vapor
ai	rain	raise	wait	brain	train	gain	pain
	chain	tail	jail	mail	snail	trail	wail
	maid	paid	fail	nail	sprain	afraid	raisin
	faint	wait	waist	paint	braid	strain	chain

Long A

Articulation: Mouth is open wide, push air from mouth, and tongue is low and toward the back of your mouth.

ay	ray	way	may	day	pay	hay	Jay
	bay	play	tray	slay	clay	gray	stray
	away	holiday	lay	spray	relay	pray	today
	hay	essay	delay	sway	betray	array	fray
ei	vein	reign	rein	reindeer	beige		
	veil	heir	feign	their			
eigh	eight	neigh	weight	sleigh	weigh		
	freight	eighty	eighteen	neighbor	sleighs		
ea	steak	great	break	breakout			
ey	hey	they	whey	survey	obey		
	grey	prey	convey	disobey	obeyed		

Long A

Tips

- * The star above the open syllable a shows us that in a word with two or more syllables, the open syllable a grapheme will represent the long a sound when it is found at the ending of a syllable. Typically this syllable is not the ending syllable, but one the first syllable of the word. (Ex. ba/by, la/dy, sha/dy)
- * When differentiating between a-e and ai, we see ai used with the ending sound of /n/ and /l/ more commonly. However, there are homophones that will use both a-e and ai.
- * When using eigh, those words will end in the eigh or they will end with a /t/ at the end of the word. Use the heart part when mapping out these words.
- * The patterns ei, eigh, ea, and ey are derived from other languages. Most of these vowel patterns were changed during the Great Vowel Shift. The best way to teach these words is by using heart parts. The Sound Mounds with this patterns are shown with the heart above the pattern.

Long E

Articulation: The mouth pulls across the face, the jaw is raised high, and the tongue is high and tense in the back of the mouth.

e-e	eve	these	use	gene	theme	
	compete	extreme	scheme	scene	believe	
	delete	athlete	here	Chinese	Pete	
	supreme complete intervene					
e - open syllable	he	she	we	be	we	zebra
	secret	recent	legal	equal	female	cedar
	neon	delete	decent	meter	fever	ego
	hero	vegan	Egypt	veto	recess	even
y	candy	baby	lady	duty	easy	sunny
	bunny	puppy	dusty	pretty	ferry	worry
	copy	silly	forty	thirty	twenty	empty
	every	funny	finally	happy	fancy	penny

Long E

Articulation: The mouth pulls across the face, the jaw is raised high, and the tongue is high and tense in the back of the mouth.

ee

bee free sleep street seed week sweet
creep feet deep tree feel jeep beef
peek beetle cheese seem keep steel teen
green see sweep screen knee meet need

ea

leaf treat dream steam feast team cream
beam bean lean eat sea pea tea
meat leash meal beach weak seam reach
please plead steal least wreath jeans eagle

ey

money honey turkey journey monkey jersey
alley valley key chimney parsley donkey
barley hockey

Long E

ē

protein	receive	ceiling	either	conceit
caffeine	Keith	deceit	neither	receipt

ē

field	piece	shield	niece	their
yield	grief	priest	relief	brief

Tips

* ee & ea can be tricky to teach to students. There is not one particular tip or trick that can be taught when encoding these words. Here is a FREE anchor chart to help. Also, ee and ea do come at the end of the words, typically being one syllable words. It is important to talk about this with your students.

* Remember, if a word has an e at the end of it that is not producing a long vowel sound, it is because the is is there to show that it is not plural. (Ex. please, cheese)

* ei & ie are both from the French origin and due to the Great Vowel Shift they still make the long E sound. These patterns can be taught as heart parts. You can remember the rule, "i before e except after c, unless the ei is making a long a sound."

* The y makes the long E sound in words with more than one syllable.

* The star above e-e and open syllable e shows that this is used most commonly in words with two or more syllables (re/peat, com/plete, be/low). When open syllable e is used, typically the syllable is not the ending syllable, but one the first syllables of the word.

Long I

Articulation: The jaw drops in a more closed position with the tongue in a low-back position in the mouth.

i-e	pike	mile	tile	file	wise	ride
	tribe	hide	tide	lite	spite	bride
	stride	knife	life	prize	hive	chime
	nine	shine	slide	wire	ripe	spice
i - open syllable	hi	I	silo	tiny	shiny	spider
	silent	item	pilot	China	Simon	library
	lion	Friday	final	giant	idea	digest
	spiral	tidal	vital	ivory	idol	iron
y	by	my	why	shy	try	fry
	fly	sly	spy	cycle	pry	dry
	deny	July	sky	defy	myself	cyclone
	satisfy	Wyoming	apply	nearby	butterfly	tyrant

Long I

Articulation: The jaw drops in a more closed position with the tongue in a low-back position in the mouth.

igh

light	right	night	knight	flight	high
bright	might	sight	tight	sigh	tonight
midnight	sightsee	sunlight	fright	blight	delight
lightening	slight	thigh	outright	mighty	fight

y-e

type	hype	Kyle	rhyme	lyme
thyme	style	enzyme	hyde	byte
hairstyle	mistype	Bryce	paralyze	analyze

ie

pie	die	tie	lie
untie	tied	lied	died

Long I

Tips

- * The star above the open syllable i shows us that in a word with two or more syllables, the open syllable a grapheme will represent the long i sound. (Ex. li/on, i/dea, pi/lot) When open syllable e is used, typically the syllable is not the ending syllable of the word, but one the first syllables of the word.
- * If we hear a /t/ at the end of a word, the grapheme igh will be used to represent the long I sound. The word high is one of the words that will end in the igh. You can teach this as a heart part depending on the grade level, however, it is a common grapheme that is used within our language.
- * In single syllable words, the long I will be represented at the end of a word with the grapheme y.
- * In multi-syllable words ending in y, typically the y grapheme will produce the /ē/. However, in some instances the grapheme y can also produce the long I phoneme (nearby, magnify, July). Be sure to map out words with students during this process to help promote the process of orthographic mapping.
- * The grapheme ie is the least common way we see the long I sound within words.

Long O

Articulation: The mouth is open and then comes together in a more rounded shape as the sound is produced.

o-e	rose nose vote rope hope phone code home cone bone note stove joke smoke clover compose stroke grove broke lobe choke slope tone dome
o - open syllable	go so no pony focus omit piano bonus donut locate moment ago hello cargo total yogurt buffalo Rosa notice open ocean okay photo over
oa	boat cloak float groan load loan moan soap roast toad soak roam coach moat road oat coat float coast foam throat goal goat roach

Long O

Articulation: The mouth is open and then comes together in a more rounded shape as the sound is produced.

ow	snow	blow	grow	low	bow	sow
	tow	crow	row	own	slow	know
	glow	below	hollow	arrow	pillow	window
	flow	show	yellow	follow	solo	potato
oe	toe	foe	doe	hoe	woe	Joe

Tips

- * The star above the open syllable o shows us that in a word with two or more syllables, the open syllable a grapheme will represent the long o sound. (Ex. o/mit, yo/gurt, po/ta/to)
- * There is no tips or tricks to teaching when to use o-e vs. oa. The best practice with these words are mapping out the sounds words and completing word sorts with these words.
- * The grapheme oe is the least common way that the long O sound is represented within words.

Long U

Articulation: The mouth moves from an open position to a rounded lip position with the tongue high and forward. The sound is /y//oo/.

u-e	cute	use	fume	confuse	huge	
	compute	mule	excuse	amuse	cube	
u - open syllable	music	unit	unicorn	humid	menu	puny
	pupil	humor	future	uniform	union	unique
	humidity	cupid	unite	human	bugle	universe
ue	rescue	argue	cue	hue	miscue	venue
	barbecue	statue	value	issue	residue	avenue

Tips

* This version of the long U represents the /y//oo/ sound. Have students focus on their mouth articulation when they are tapping these words out. Think of a cat and mew (a high pitched meow).

* Sometimes the ew and eu graphemes can also make the long U sound. (Ex. few, pew, mew & Europe, feud, eulogy)

Long U

Articulation: The jaw is slightly lowered and the tongue is raised in a mid-high position. This is the /oo/ sound.

u-e	tube	rule	tune	flute	June
	flume	chute	dune	Luke	spruce
	rude	salute	dude	rude	absolute
u - open syllable	student	ruby	numeral	duty	super
	truth	ruin	lunar	stupid	Peru
	tuna	studio	rumor	Jupiter	tulip
oo	moon	soon	raccoon	food	balloon
	roof	proof	room	zoo	moo
	smooth	zoom	too	root	spoon
ue	blue	true	glue	due	
	sue	rue	blue	clue	

Long U

Articulation: The jaw is slightly lowered and the tongue is raised in a mid-high position. This is the /oo/ sound.

ew	dew	crew	new	flew	stew
	chew	drew	stew	sew	jewel
	mew	grew	shrewd	threw	screw
		knew	brew	blew	
ui	fruit	suit	juice	pursuit	
	bruise	cruise	suitcase	recruit	
ou	group	soup	you	youth	coupon
	wound	route	cougar	croup	recoup

Tips

* This version of the long U represents the /oo/ sound. Have students focus on their mouth articulation when they are tapping these words out. Think of a cow saying moo. There are no strict rules on when to use these graphemes, so sound mapping of words is extremely important.

* A trick word that would fall into this category is the word through.

R-CONTROLLED VOWELS

R-Controlled Vowel AR

Articulation: The tongue is flat, mouth is open, and the jaw starts to close slightly.

ar	tar	star	farm	barn	alarm
	car	bar	park	dark	harm
	arm	chart	spark	smart	market
	apart	yard	garlic	sparkle	target
	harp	hark	harvest	bark	carbon
	shark	par	charge	remark	carpet

Tips

* The r-controlled vowel AR can be found at the beginning, middle, and ending sounds of words or syllables. Sound mapping of words is extremely important within these sounds.

* The word heart contains the ear grapheme producing the /ar/ phoneme. This would be a heart part of the word. (The ear grapheme can also produce the long E controlled like in ear or /er/ like in Earth.)

R-Controlled Vowel $\bar{A}R$

Articulation: The mouth starts in the long a position, but then glides into slightly closed mouth with air breathing out for r control.

air	air	chair	fair	hair	pair
	dairy	stairs	eclair	despair	repair
are	bare	care	far	flare	scare
	dare	hare	mare	rare	aware
	stare	square	share	glare	mare
ear	bear	pear	wear	swear	

Tips

- * The r-controlled vowel $\bar{A}R$ can be found at the end of words or syllables.
- * ARE is the most frequent grapheme that represents the / $\bar{a}r$ / phoneme.
- * EAR is the less frequent grapheme that represents the / $\bar{a}r$ /phoneme. EAR can make three different sounds, so sound mapping of words becomes very important for this sound because it can be a heart part.

R-Controlled Vowel OR

Articulation: The mouth starts in the short /o/, but then glides into slightly closed mouth with air breathing out for r control.

or	fork	pork	cork	short	horn
	corn	born	torn	dorm	hornet
	orbit	form	acorn	forth	glory
	organ	horse	snort	short	storm
	resort	worn	story	porch	forgot
ore	adore	before	bore	galor	foresee
	chore	more	tore	pore	gore
	bored	store	spore	score	ignore
	explore	core	lore	wore	scores
oar	oar	board	boar	soar	hoard
	cardboard	roar	hoarse	coarse	uproar

R-Controlled Vowel OR

Articulation: The mouth starts in the short /o/, but then glides into slightly closed mouth with air breathing out for r control.

our	mourn	pour	tour	court	gourd
		your	four	course	

Tips

* There are graphemes that represent the /or/ phoneme. Out of the graphemes, the most common are or in the middle and ore at the end. When introducing these two graphemes, you can use the following chant:

Should we use or or ore,
let's find the sound to see!
If the sound is in the middle, or it is!
If it's at the end ore it will be!

In the word for, the or does go at the end with out the e. This could be mapped as a heart part if you choose, just to grasp the word and help the process of orthographic mapping.

If you hear /or/ in a multi-syllable word, the or will represent the or. (Ex. or/bit, or/gan, or/gan/ize)

* OUR is found in the number four, which can be introduced as a heart part of a word. These words should be mapped out by sounds.

* OOR can also produce the /or/ phoneme like in floor, door, & poor, but it is not common.

R-Controlled Vowel ER

Articulation: Lips are slightly rounded and the mouth is slightly open with the tongue being in the middle of the mouth.

ir	bird	chirp	dirt	fir	birth	firm
	first	flirt	girl	irk	sir	shirt
	skirt	third	thirteen	swirl	twirl	whirl
	birch	circus	confirm	quirk	squirm	smirk
ur	blur	burp	curl	curve	curse	curb
	blurt	burst	turn	turf	fur	hurt
	lurk	purse	nurse	spurt	disturb	flurry
	scurry	sturdy	turnip	burn	hurl	surprise
er	her	herd	fern	jerk	per	letter
	after	butter	center	dinner	hammer	lobster
	nerve	perfect	mercy	kernel	holler	copper
	number	bitter	tiger	term	verb	verse

R-Controlled Vowel ER

Articulation: Lips are slightly rounded and the mouth is slightly open with the tongue being in the middle of the mouth.

ear	earth	heard	early	pearl	search
		learn	earn	pearly	

Tips

*There are three main ways that we hear the /er/ sound produced. IR, UR, & ER are all graphemes that represent the /er/ phoneme. Out of the three, ER is the most frequently used grapheme, especially at the end of a word or syllable. (Ex. per/fect, ti/ger, cop/per, ham/mer) This does not mean that IR and UR cannot be found at the end of words or syllables.

There is not one tip or trick that can help with these words. I do suggest doing many word sorts and taking a look at the generalizations below to go with each of the graphemes. These are just generalizations and not a one size fits all, so please use as needed.

*ER: Goes at the end of a word or syllable, most frequently used, typically used within words with more than one syllable.

*IR: Nature (bird, dirt, dirt, chirp)

Numbers (first, thirteen, thirty)

Clothing (skirt, shirt)

Movement (twirl, whirl, squirm, smirk)

*UR: Health (nurse, burn, hurt)

*EAR is a heart part of a word, and is only seen a few times representing /er/.

R-Controlled Vowel ĒR

Articulation: The mouth starts in the long e position, but then glides into slightly closed mouth with air breathing out for r control.

ear	gear	dear	hear	fear	near	sear
	year	rear	ear	earring	clear	appear
	smear	spear	tear	beard	shear	unclear
eer	cheer	peer	steer	deer	career	
		sneer	jeer	engineer		
ere	sphere	sincere	here	cashmere	adhere	

Tips

*There are three main ways that we hear the /ēṛ/ sound produced. The most common common grapheme that represents this sound is EAR. This is the most common phoneme that EAR represents, too.

* There are haert parts of words that can be taught with this phoneme. Words like where & there have the ere but produce a long /āṛ/ phoneme. This can be taught with a heart part of the word to help retention of the phoneme and grapheme correspondence.

R-Controlled Vowel ĪR

Articulation: The mouth starts in the long I position, but then glides into slightly closed mouth with air breathing out for r control.

	fire	hire	mire	sire	tire	wire
ire	satire	aspire	attire	desire	entire	rewire
	sapphire	umpire	vampire	retire	entire	enquire

Tips

*Teaching the words with the ire with the r controlling the vowel can be considered a trigraph. Best practice for teaching this is sound mapping of words to promote orthographic mapping and allowing the students to read these words in context.

DIPHTHONGS

Diphthongs OI & OY

Articulation: The lips are rounded at the beginning of the sound, then the sound moves from the back to the front and the lips are slightly open.

oi	boil	soil	coin	join	point	voice
	choice	void	avoid	hoist	joint	spoil
	sirloin	anoint	exploit	poison	moist	oil
	embroider	toil	oink	broil	coil	rejoice
oy	joy	royal	annoy	employ	destroy	cowboy
	boy	enjoy	Troy	deploy	oyster	ploy
	toy	loyal	ahoy	decoy	convoy	alloy
	soy	enjoys	destroys	annoys	deploys	deployed

Tips

* If a word begins with OI (ex. oil), the student will use the oi unless the word has more than one syllable (ex. oy/ster). In oyster, the /oi/ syllable is by itself, so the grapheme to use would be oy. Also think of words like roy/al and loy/al. Remember, Sound Mounds represent words and syllables, so for these words be sure to use sound mapping and be sure to look at where the phoneme is heard in the word. However, there are exceptions to that rule like in the word poi/son.

Diphthongs OU & OW

Articulation: The mouth starts open with the tongue at the bottom of the mouth, and moves into the lips rounding and the tongue moves slightly back in the mouth.

ou	cloud	house	round	sound	mouth	shout
	stout	about	ouch	out	south	count
	amount	found	route	scout	doubt	pout
	trout	spout	sprout	aloud	loud	foul
ow	cow	plow	bow	clown	towel	shower
	howl	town	frown	crown	vowel	growl
	owl	now	pow	vow	wow	brow
	brown	gown	fowl	prow	drown	chow

Tips

- * If a word begins with /ou/ (ex. ouch), the student will use the ou unless the word has more than one syllable (ex. me/ow). In meow, the /ou/ syllable is by itself, so it would be the ow. Remember, Sound Mounds represent words and syllables, so for these words be sure to use sound mapping.
- * If the /ou/ phoneme is followed by /l/ or /n/, the ow grapheme will be used.
- * The ow grapheme can also make /ō/ so be sure to practice these words in context.

Diphthongs AU & AW

Articulation: The mouth is slightly rounded with the tongue in the middle of the mouth, and then the tongue slightly rounds up at the end of the sound.

au	sauce	cause	August	haunt	fraud	pause
	maul	autumn	gauze	mauve	audio	launch
	saucer	caution	auction	author	astronaut	clause
	because	haul	laundry	exhaust	applause	audit
aw	paw	saw	caw	raw	law	lawn
	claw	brawl	hawk	draw	drawn	pawn
	dawn	yawn	jaw	flaw	draw	straw
	cawk	crawl	thaw	bawl	jigsaw	seesaw

Tips

* If the beginning syllable of word is /au/ (ex. Au/gust), the student will use the au.

* If the /au/ phoneme is followed by /k/, /l/, or /n/, the aw grapheme will be used.

*Fun Fact: The word awesome is an exception to this word because this word originates from the base word awe and suffix -some. The words awesome and awful used to be synonyms, in which aw/ful derived from the baseword of awe, meaning full of awe. Now, these two words are antonyms due to the evolution of our language. You can teach awe/some as a heart part.

CONSONANTS & DIGRAPHS

/b/

Articulation: The lips are closed and pressed together to produce the outward sound.

b - beginning	bag	bat	bug	big	bet	bit
	bike	ball	bell	bake	bait	bin
	book	band	barn	bib	beach	baby
	brush	bridge	bear	blanket	bush	buck
b - end	rib	mob	cob	cub	web	stub
	crab	job	slab	tub	curb	snub
	grab	snob	dab	chub	knob	crib
	brag	throb	blab	Barb	slob	snib

Tips

* If students struggle with letter b/d reversal, try this activity linked [HERE](#)

/d/

Articulation: The lips are slightly open and the tip of the tongue is pressed behind the teeth. Push air out of your mouth and stop the tongue.

d - beginning	dog	dig	dish	dab	doll	dress
	drum	dad	dot	dirt	duck	den
	down	disk	dip	dice	desk	disk
	dream	dive	drip	dozen	drift	dragon
d - end	lid	led	rid	ride	lend	bird
	pond	wind	loud	word	road	head
	red	seed	need	cold	old	found
	round	remind	feed	bed	bid	said

Tips

* If students struggle with letter b/d reversal, try this activity linked [HERE](#)

/f/

Articulation: Rest your top teeth on your bottom lip and blow.

f - beginning	fun	fix	fox	fig	fog	fib
	flip	frog	fill	fly	fall	fire
	fate	face	fine	flag	flash	food
	fork	fable	faint	frown	free	fur
f(f) - end	staff	cliff	buff	leaf	turf	reef
	roof	bluff	off	if	of	cuff
	wharf	loaf	golf	riff	calf	sniff
	stuff	beef	deaf	poof	proof	fluff

Tips

* When /f/ is heard at the ending of words when following a short vowel, the grapheme will be ff (sniff, cliff, buff). If there is a long vowel or another vowel team, you will just use the f (reef, leaf, safe). You can use the following chant when teaching the doubling of the f and the other letters this rule applies to:

F, L, S, and Sometimes Z,
do I need two let's check and see!
Here we have a short vowel,
so I need 2 I'll show you how!

/g/

Articulation: The jaw is slightly dropped and the back of the tongue raises up to the back of the mouth.

g - beginning	gift	gig	gosh	grin	go	glide
	gone	gum	gust	gas	got	gob
	group	gather	grant	gallon	gush	gallop
	glance	grape	garden	game	give	gold
g - end	jog	dig	fig	snug	drag	tag
	dug	hug	rag	slug	brag	smug
	pug	gag	frog	leg	pig	mug
	big	jug	bug	log	flag	bag

Tips

* When /g/ is heard at the beginning of a word, the letters to follow will typically be a, o, and u. When the grapheme g is followed by an i, e, or y it most commonly makes the /j/ phoneme, or the soft g sound. (Ex. gem, giraffe, gym)

* If an e follows the g grapheme at the end of a word, it is going to make the /j/ phoneme. (Ex: cage, rage, badge)

/h/

Articulation: The mouth fully opens and you push a breath outwards.

h - beginning

hat

hot

help

hug

hut

hip

hit

hope

hike

hide

help

hush

hair

hand

hall

hack

hitch

hill

hammer

harvest

house

happy

herd

high

horn

hobby

husky

hobby

hunger

habit

Tips

* The letter h is not found at the end of the words as a singular grapheme. It is found at the end when it is found with digraphs or trigraphs (sh, ch, tch), but they do not represent the /h/ phoneme.

/j/

Articulation: Your mouth is almost closed and the teeth are together, the tongue flattens out and moves slightly down when pushing the sound. This is a voiced sound.

j	jig	jug	jet	jog	Jack	jelly
	joke	jam	jaw	jolly	joint	joust
	junk	July	jade	joker	juggle	joy
	jungle	jingle	jacket	jump	jolt	jewel
g	gym	gentle	gem	genius	giant	George
	ginger	gesture	germ	budget	gist	general
	digest	gel	digital	engine	gene	danger
ge	age	rage	cage	beige	wage	huge
	large	page	stage	orge	cringe	voyage
	charge	surge	range	change	barge	purge
	lunge	urge	merge	cringe	hinge	bulge

/j/

Articulation: Your mouth is almost closed and the teeth are together, the tongue flattens out and moves slightly down when pushing the sound. This is a voiced sound.

	bridge	ridge	hedge	ledge	edge	lodge
ge	fudge	badge	ledge	pledge	sludge	smudge
	grudge	wedge	dodge	nudge	gridge	badge

Tips

- * When /g/ is heard at the beginning of a word, the letters to follow will typically be a, o, and u. When the grapheme g is followed by an i, e, or y it most commonly makes the /j/ phoneme. (Ex. gem, giraffe, gym) This is known as the soft g.
- * If an e follows the g grapheme at the end of a word, it is going to make the /j/ phoneme. (Ex: cage, rage, badge)
- * The -dge is used at the ending of a word when there is a short vowel sound prior to the /j/. (Ex. badge, bridge, edge)
- * the -ge is used at the ending of a word when there is a long vowel sound. (Ex. cage, rage, sage, beige)
- * The sounds /j/ and /ch/ can be easily mixed up due to mouth articulation.
- * Remember, in multi-syllable words consider the placement of all syllables. For example, in the word danger, It is broken up dan/ger. The second syllable is ger, in which the first phoneme we hear is /j/. This would be represented with the g grapheme because the letter that follows is er, which begins with an e.

/k/

Articulation: The tongue starts raised in the back touching the roof of your mouth, and air is pushed out and the tongue moves forward.

c	car	cat	cake	can	cap	cod
k	case	camp	care	card	came	come
ck	cop	cave	cuff	cuddle	candle	cold
	cast	cook	cup	cape	cot	call
	kite	kick	kid	kiss	key	Kim
	kit	kitten	kind	keep	kelp	kept
	kitchen	kettle	kennel	keypad	krill	kink
	kale	kindle	kilt	kangaroo	keen	kayak
	duck	rock	sack	Jack	brick	stick
	chick	clock	block	sock	crack	back
	blake	snack	truck	yuck	lick	dock
	click	lick	Nick	peck	quack	flock

/k/

Articulation: The tongue starts raised in the back touching the roof of your mouth, and air is pushed out and the tongue moves forward.

k-ending	cake rake hike bike plank Frank freak frisk leak like kayak Greek pink spark lark dark shark poke hulk silk rusk sank make m
c- ending	picnic attic music basic comic panic artic epic classic civic magic traffic logic plastic organic romantic public graphic specific elastic frolic Pacific
ch	chemical school chorus chord chaos character monarch stomach tech chrome scheme ache mechanic schedule orchid

/k/

Tips

* The graphemes k and c can both produce the /k/ phonemes. You can use the following rhyme to help with the spelling:

K takes I & E, C takes the other three! (a, o, u)

You can also use cat and kite visuals for this, too.

* When using the digraph -ck, this digraph can only be found at the end of words where a short vowel comes before it. (Ex. kick, pack, puck, peck, lock) You can use the following chant when teaching this digraph:

The only way we can use -ck is if it's following a short vowel - aye or nay? (The students will draw an arrow to the vowel or consonant that comes before the digraph. It must be a short vowel to use -ck. They will give you an aye (yes) if it is a short vowel or a nay (no) if it is something else)

* When a vowel team, r-controlled vowel, or consonant comes before the /k/ at the ending of a word, you will use the grapheme k. (Ex. cake, peek, junk)

* To use -c at the ending of a word, it must be a multi-syllabic word with a short vowel that comes before the /k/ phoneme. (Ex. pic/nic, at/tic, pan/ic)

/k/

Tips

* The grapheme ch will sometimes make the /k/ phoneme. When this happens, the words that produce this sound come from the Greek origin. There is no simple tip or trick to teaching this tricky grapheme, but this is a great example of when to use heart parts of words. The words below can be taught using heart parts of words. The underlined part of the word would be the heart part.

s ch oo l

ch e m / i s / t r y

s t o m / a ch

ch a / o s

ch e m / i / c a l

//

Articulation: The tip of your tongue is placed right above the back of your teeth, and you push out air to produce the sound.

—

lap	list	lock	lump	lend	lip
lost	luck	lift	leg	log	lemon
lamp	leaf	love	land	lake	leak
lunch	lady	lizard	line	lion	ladder

=

bill	bell	doll	drill	fell	gull
Jill	hill	spell	grill	fill	chill
yell	well	still	pill	swell	tall
sale	mail	tail	reel	peel	meal

_e

puzzle	handle	castle	gentle	simple	apple
turtle	circle	riddle	wobble	cradle	puddle
snuggle	sparkle	juggle	wiggle	saddle	tumble
twinkle	wrinkle	little	bottle	paddle	stumble

//

Articulation: The tip of your tongue is placed right above the back of your teeth, and you push out air to produce the sound.

l

angel	camel	tunnel	jewel	label	hotel
model	travel	barrel	vowel	cancel	mantel
novel	oixel	Laurel	navel	tinsel	hazel
diesel	rebel	towel	kennel	squirrel	apparel

ll

mammal	formal	animal	capital	metal	hospital
crystal	signal	tropical	festival	journal	general
casual	proposal	literal	physical	critical	principal
gital	musical	national	chemical	memorial	comical

Tips

* When /l/ is heard at the ending of words when following a short vowel, the grapheme will be ll (pill, still, well). If there is a long vowel or another vowel team, you will just use the l (peel, sale, mail). You can use the following chant when teaching the doubling of the f and the other letters this rule applies to:

F, L, S, and Sometimes Z,
do I need two let's check and see!
Here we have a short vowel,
so I need 2 I'll show you how!

Tips

* There are three // graphemes that represent the // phonemes. These graphemes are -le, -el, and -al, and they all come at the ending of a word.

The most common of the three is the grapheme -le. This grapheme typically follows a consonant and consonants that are tall letters or tail letters (b, d, t, p). Refer to the list above for examples. When teaching this, it is important that you are teaching at the c+le syllable rule. Every syllable needs a vowel, so if you hear the // and there is no vowel with that syllable, an e will be added. (ma/ple, hum/ble, lit/tle)

When dividing syllables with these words, you can have students go back and count. For example, with the word cattle, have students start at the e. Go back and have them see if there is the L AND a consonant before the vowel. Then they will divide the syllable before the consonant. (cat/tle)

The next most common grapheme is -el. We typically use this word when the // sound is alone in the syllable and does not have a consonant following (nov/el, reb/el) however, this is not always the case. The el also follows letters that are small letters (n, m, w, v, r).

The least common grapheme is -al. These words often are used to describe or show an action. -al can also be used as a suffix, so it is important to talk through the changing of the base word, too.

/m/

Articulation: The lips are closed together and air is pushed out through the nose. The mouth does not open. This is a nasal sound. (Voiced Sound)

m- beginning	mapmanmudmistmopmuck millmilkmailmagicmathmove mangomonkeymarchmuffinmittenmanner mistakemoosemousemerrymagnetmusic
m- ending	jamPamcampslambamwham swimdrumstormplumstembeam chumphrismbroomgroomclam bloom wormscamdreamzoomcreamteam gametame timemime whine sum
mb	climb comb bomb thumb lamb limb numb womb crumb dumb

/m/

mn

autumn

column

condemn

hymn

solemn

Tips

* The /m/ phoneme is known as a nasal sound. This happens because the air flows out from the nose and the vocal cords vibrate to make the sound. This gives this phoneme a nasal sound, which is why when the /m/ follows a short /a/, it produces a whiny sound. This is important to discuss with students when targeting these words. There are extra words in the ending m words so that you can target these with students.

* The digraph -mb is found only at the ending of words. In Middle English, both letters of this grapheme used to be pronounced and you would hear the b at the ending. However, this changed during the Great Vowel Switch. Within the grapheme -mb, the b is silent. You can teach this as a heart part with students. This grapheme actually originated from Germany.

* The digraph -mn is also found at the end of words. This is the least frequent way we hear this sound. This grapheme should be taught as a heart part in words.

/n/

Articulation: The front part of the tongue is pressed against the top of the mouth directly behind the teeth. For this sound, the vocal cords vibrate and air leaves through the noes. This is a voiced sound.

n	net	nap	nut	not	nest	nose
	name	nine	neck	nickel	nail	nurse
	never	nose	night	nice	nope	new
	next	number	nibble	nudge	napkin	north
kn	knit	knife	knight	knob	knot	kneel
	knack	knew	know	knuckle	knap	knish
gn	snome	gnaw	gnat	gnash	gnocchi	gnarly
n	fun	sun	run	win	pen	ten
	pan	ban	man	can	line	mine
	mane	lion	lemon	lane	lesson	falcon
	pattern	ribbon	pumpkin	cabin	oceand	dolphin

Articulation: The front part of the tongue is pressed against the top of the mouth directly behind the teeth. For this sound, the vocal cords vibrate and air leaves through the noes. This is a voiced sound.

gn - ending	design	reign	sign	assign	resign
		assignment	align		

Tips

- * The /n/ phoneme is known as a nasal sound. This happens because the air flows out from the nose and the vocal cords vibrate to make the sound. This gives this phoneme a nasal sound, which is why when the /n/ follows a short /a/, it produces a whiny sound. This is important to discuss with students when focusing on these words.
- * The digraph kn is found only at the beginning of words. In Middle English, both letters of this grapheme used to be pronounced and you would hear the /k/ at the ending. However, this changed during the Great Vowel Switch. Within the grapheme kn, the k is silent. You can teach this as a heart part with students. The kn also has originated from Germany.
- * The digraph gn is also found at the beginning and ending of words. We do not hear the /g/ within this sound. This is the least frequent way we hear this sound. This grapheme should be taught as a heart part in words. This digraph originates from Latin/Greek.

/p/

Articulation: The lips are pressed together and air is held behind the lips. The air presses out to make the sound.

p - beginning	pin	pan	pass	pick	pill	Pam
	pig	play	paw	pond	pop	pail
	plane	pine	pace	poke	pizza	purple
	puppy	pencil	park	pillow	puzzle	pocket
p - ending	cup	cop	cap	tip	tap	lap
	nap	clip	jump	help	sleep	ship
	crisp	stamp	slope	pope	flip	sharp
	drop	clasp	cape	type	wipe	sweep

Tips

* Sometimes, the grapheme p is confused with the letters b, d, and q. Click [HERE](#) for a reversal activity to help teach this common reversal.

/kw/

Articulation: The tongue starts raised in the back touching the roof of your mouth /k/ and moves into the rounding of the lips /w/

qu	quick	quack	quiz	quilt	quote	quit
	quake	quail	queen	quiet	quiver	quest
	quench	quirk	quote	question	qualify	quibble
	quirky	quilted	quicksand	quotient	quantity	quarter
qu with blend	squid	squawk	square	equator	equal	
	equip	squat	squab	squib	squad	

Tips

- * Sometimes, the grapheme q is confused with the letters b, d, and g. Click [HERE](#) for a reversal activity to help teach this common reversal.
- * Q is always followed by the u. You can tell your students Q & U are stuck like glue!
- * The grapheme qu producing the /kw/ sound is only found at the beginning of words. If the qu is found at the end of a word, it will produce the /k/ phoneme (plaque, mosque).

/r/

Articulation: The tongue is flat (floating) with the back of the tongue down and the lips are slightly open. The air is pushed out of the mouth.

r	red	rug	rig	run	race	rash
	rack	rush	ring	rope	rule	rain
	read	ride	rocket	ribbon	round	road
	reward	river	robot	radio	reward	report
wr	write	wrap	wreck	wrong	wrist	wrinkle
	wrestle	wrange	wrath	wren	wrench	wreath

Tips

- * The grapheme r is found at the beginning of words. When r is at the end of words, it is controlled by a vowel which changes the phoneme that it produces.
- * The grapheme wr is a digraph that is found at the beginning of words. In this grapheme the w is silent in which the /r/ phoneme is produced. Again, like other digraphs, both letters used to be pronounced, but during the Great Vowel Switch this changed. This digraph comes from German origins. There are many homophones when teaching these words (write/right, ring/wring) so it is important to teach these words in context. The wr can be a heart part of a word until students grasp the spelling.

/s/

Articulation: The tip of your tongue is placed right behind the upper teeth, the mouth is slightly open, and the air is pressed down the middle of the tongue.

s	sun	son	sap	sick	sock	sand
	snake	shell	star	sail	swing	sip
	ship	shut	smile	sleep	space	seed
	stick	sloth	steam	snail	speed	shirt
c	cell	city	center	celery	citrus	cement
	acid	cereal	circle	civil	citizen	cycle
	fancy	recent	cancel	cinema	cease	certain
	circut	cent	century	cider	celebrate	ceiling
ss	grass	class	glass	dress	mass	pass
	mess	kiss	miss	boss	floss	toss
	cross	discuss	success	address	princess	compass
	stress	guess	less	press	miss	bliss

/s/

Articulation: The tip of your tongue is placed right behind the upper teeth, the mouth is slightly open, and the air is pressed down the middle of the tongue.

c	race	space	dance	trace	trance	chance
	ice	mice	place	once	peace	voice
	choice	prince	slice	brace	force	service
	fence	grace	balance	practice	science	surface
s	house	horse	mouse	case	base	cheese
	moose	loose	close	noise	erase	promise
	use	fuse	cause	choose	chase	wise
		increase	release	exercise	cease	

Tips

* Both of the graphemes s and c can produce the /s/ phoneme. However, the c can only make the /s/ when it is making the soft sound. The letters i, e, and y change the c grapheme from representing the /k/ phoneme to the c representing the /s/ phoneme. We must remember that Sound Mound represent words AND syllables, so when decoding two or more syllable words, we must watch for the pattern. (Ex. city, can/cel, ci/der)

Tips

* When /s/ is heard at the ending of words when following a short vowel, the grapheme will be ss (mess, press, less). You can use the following chant when teaching the doubling of the f and the other letters this rule applies to:

F, L, S, and Sometimes Z,
do I need two let's check and see!
Here we have a short vowel,
so I need 2 I'll show you how!

* When the /s/ phoneme is heard at the ending of a word that is not followed by a short vowel sound, it is often followed by an e. The reason behind this is so that the word can become plural when needed. The e's job is to show that the object being talked about is singular or acting as a verb. (Ex. horse, house, erase)

* When the grapheme ce is at the end of a word, the c will produce the /s/ phoneme. This is also known as the soft c. The soft c can be found at the beginning and at the ending of words or syllables. We do see the grapheme -ce more often than the grapheme -se. There is no single tip or trick, but when the /s/ is found at the ending of a word and the phoneme /n/ comes before, then it will most likely be the -ce grapheme at the end of the word (dance, prance, chance). We also see -ce with nouns (dice, rice, mice) more often and -se more frequently with verbs (erase, chase, close). However, these rules are interchangeable so sound mapping of words is best practice. In some instances the se does sound like the /z/.

/t/

Articulation: The tip of your tongue touches above the back teeth on the ride of the teeth. Then the mouth stays open and the air is pushed from the mouth to make the sound.

t - beginning	tip	tap	top	tick	tuck	trash
	tot	tag	tail	tank	tickle	train
	tree	tiger	toy	tulip	teacher	table
	time	tale	tame	team	taste	tent
t - ending	cat	bat	hat	flat	basket	dot
	robot	carpet	magnet	rocket	jacket	puppet
	rabbit	planet	sunset	insect	smart	cart
	part	mitten	button	secret	orbit	bucket

Tips

* The grapheme t is found at both the beginning and the ending of words or syllables.

* A rule to keep in mind is when there is a two syllable words with a short vowel the consonant will double into the next syllable (but/ton, mit/ten). A rhyme to add is:

If it is a short vowel I see, don't forget to double me!

/v/

Articulation: The top teeth touch the bottom lip softly, and the vocal cords produce the sound by pushing air out of the mouth.

v - beginning	vet	visit	vine	village	visitor	vehicle
	victory	vanish	vase	velvet	volume	vision
	vibrant	veto	video	volley	voice	vegetable
	vitamin	violet	volunteer	view	vulture	venture
ve	give	love	have	move	drive	above
	curve	shave	dive	olive	cave	brave
	solve	nerve	drive	behave	positive	sleeve
	hive	grieve	twelve	improve	wove	salve

Tips

* The grapheme v is only found at the beginning of words. In the English language, words cannot end with the consonant v. In this case, the grapheme e must be present with the v to follow this rule.

In the case of the word have, this is commonly mistaken as an irregular word. However, have has the ve grapheme at the end due to the rule of v not being at the ending of words. Therefore, this can be taught as a heart part of words. (Ex. give, have, love, above follow this rule)

/w/

Articulation: The lips are rounded and the lips glide into a more open mouth shape with the mouth pushing air to make the sound. This is a glide.

w	win	wash	watch	walk	wave	wipe
	wait	water	wand	want	wish	wag
	wagon	wasp	wing	wet	wild	word
	warm	wiggle	wood	waddle	witch	wallet
wh	what	why	when	who	where	whale
	wheel	whisper	whisk	whip	while	white
	which	wharf	whack	wham	whimper	wheeze
	whether	whose	wheat	whimsy	whine	whiz

Tips

* The grapheme w is only found at the beginning of words. In the English language, words do not end with the singular phoneme /w/. You will see the w at the end of words when it is being represented in a grapheme like ow, aw, and ew.

* The grapheme wh is a digraph in which it produces the /w/ phoneme.

Tips

* With the wh digraph, there are a few generalizations that can be followed when teaching how to differentiate grapheme from the w. These categories fall under the following:

Short Vowels go with W:

If a short vowel is found after the /w/ phoneme, the w grapheme will be used. (web, want, wick, went)

Words with Silent-E:

If a word contains the silent-e at the ending, the digraph wh will be used. (whale, white, while)

Question Words:

If the word is a question word, it will begin with the digraph wh. (who, what, when, where, why)

Action/Sound Words:

If the word is an action or a sound word, the digraph wh will be used. (whisk, whoosh, whistle)

* When looking at words that begin with the letter w, often times the grapheme a that follows will produce the schwa sound. This is due to the changing of the sound throughout the history of the English language. The /w/ phoneme does influence mouth articulation too, so these can be taught as heart parts of words. (want, watch, wash)

/ks/

Articulation: The mouth starts the /k/ position and then is stopped in the /s/ position.

x - ending	fox	mix	fax	max	wax	lux
	pox	flax	ox	six	rex	jinx
	faux	flex	sax	nix	tux	vex

Tips

* The grapheme x is most typically found at the ending of words or syllables. The x rarely produces the pronunciation of the letter such as in the word x-ray. It is important that when working with this word, students have the opportunity to spell words with the /x/ ending. Use the word list above to help with this.

/y/

Articulation: The tongue starts in the middle of the mouth with the tip point raised, and the tongue moves toward the front of the mouth.

	yes	yak	yell	yolk	yelp	yet
>	yellow	yogurt	year	yawn	yard	young
	yum	yodel	yield	yule	yahoo	yeti

Tips

* The grapheme y is most typically found at the beginning of words or syllables. The y will not produce the /y/ phoneme at the end of a word because in this case it will produce the /ī/ or /ē/ phoneme.

/z/

Articulation: The tongue is close to the roof of the mouth and the vocal cords will vibrate and push the air between the teeth.

z - beginning	zoo	zone	zero	zip	zebra	zest
	zoom	zip	zipper	zing	zap	happy
	zingy	zigzag	zucchini	zit	zen	zapped
s	was	is	his	has	close	cruise
	vision	measure	busy	rose	disease	lose
zz	buzz	jazz	fizz	razz	frizz	fuzz

Tips

* When /z/ is heard at the ending of words when following a short vowel, the grapheme will be zz (buzz, jazz, frizz). You can use the following chant when teaching the doubling of the f and the other letters this rule applies to:

F, L, S, and Sometimes Z,

do I need two let's check and see!

Here we have a short vowel,

so I need 2 I'll show you how!

Tips

* The grapheme s can sometimes make the /z/ sound. This happens frequently when the grapheme s is in between two vowels (cruise, busy, rose). In words such as was, is, his, and has, it is important to teach these high frequency words to students and discuss that in this case the s does produce the /z/ phoneme. This can be taught as a heart part until students gain understanding of the phoneme. This is based on teachers' opinions, as some like to teach the word as a heart part and others do not. Do what you feel is best for your students based on this case.

The suffix s can also produce the /z/ phoneme, but it is important to teach students base words and then add affixes so that students can contextually understand the word and how it changes with a specific affix.

/ch/

Articulation: The tip of your tongue is placed right behind the upper teeth, the mouth is slightly open, and the air is pressed down the middle of the tongue.

ch	cheese chair check chase chalk chirp chatter chute chive child chubby chomp cherry chimney charity challenge chapter chore chunk chuckle chop chill chess chip
ch - ending	branch parch perch reach teach belch trench bench clinch mulch pouch lunch quench scorch screech peach punch pooch pinch touch poach porch ranch roach
-tch	stitch watch match scratch stretch patch witch fetch pitch snitch snatch itch hatch butcher kitchen hutch ketchup batch switch latch sketch notch ditch twitch

Tips

* The phoneme /ch/ can be found at both the beginning and ending of words or syllables. When teaching the progression of this phonemes, the graphemes that go along with each of the graphemes that represent /ch/ should be considered.

When /ch/ comes at the beginning of a word, the most common graphemes that follow are long vowel teams or r-controlled vowels. This can be difficult for beginning readers who have not been introduced to these sounds yet. There are some words that do start with the ch grapheme and have short vowels follow like chip, chess, and chick.

When /ch/ comes at the ending of a word, the same concept follows as discussed above. We use the ch at the end of a word when there is a long vowel team, diphthong, or r-controlled vowel that comes before the /ch/. Examples of these words include peach and porch. However, if there is a consonant before the /ch/ as in punch, the ch grapheme will be used.

Another /ch/ ending is represented by the -tch grapheme. This only comes at the ending of words or syllables. The -tch is used when there is a short vowel before the /ch/ sound. Examples of these words include stitch, swatch, and watch.

I think it is important to teach students the -tch ending early in their writing, because this is an important rule to know.

/th/

Articulation: The tip of your tongue is placed between the teeth and air blows through the teeth. (UNVOICED)

th - beginning	thin	thorn	thud	thank	thaw	thirst
	three	thrive	thunder	thrash	throw	thrill
	thrust	thirteen	thief	thimble	thwart	throw
th - end	cloth	path	moth	youth	broth	north
	worth	faith	tooth	sooth	both	wrath

Tips

* When the /th/ produces the unvoiced sound, it is purely air being pushed through the teeth. The students can put their hands on their throats to see if the vocal cords are vibrating or not when studying these words.

/th/

Articulation: The tip of your tongue is placed between the teeth and air is pushed out and the vocal cords vibrate. (VOICED)

th - beginning	the	them	these	they	that	those
	thus	there	brother	father	gather	their
th - end	bathe	teethe	breathe	clothe	smooth	
	fifth	sixth	seventh	hath		

Tips

* When the /th/ produces the unvoiced sound, it is air is pushed out and the vocal cords vibrate. The students can put their hands on their throats to see if the vocal cords are vibrating or not when studying these words.

/sh/

Articulation: The teeth are together and the lips come together in the corners and the lips pucker out. Air is pushed out to make the sound.

sh - beginning	ship	shrug	shirt	shelf	shock	shave
	shine	shin	short	shot	sheep	show
	shy	shed	share	sharp	sheer	shiver
	shovel	shrine	shop	short	shack	shadow
sh - end	wish	push	dish	gush	brush	flash
	rash	cash	harsh	splash	lash	rush
	slush	thrash	Trish	plush	push	bush
	hush	fish	posh	crush	mush	squish

Tips

* The grapheme sh can be found at both the beginning and ending parts of words or syllables. The /sh/ phoneme can be mistaken for the /ch/, so be sure to model the mouth articulation for this phoneme.

* The suffix -ish can often times be mistaken for the grapheme sh. Be sure to differentiate this learning with students when they are writing the words and explicitly teach the -ish suffix.

GLUED SOUNDS

When teaching glued sounds, there are often times dialects that change the sound that is produced. Use this as you wish within your class. Each of the glued sounds contain a word list and an explanation if applicable.

/all/

al

salt

salsa

palm

bald

scald

calm

always

malt

Walt

Walter

halt

salty

all

ball

hall

fall

wall

call

tall

small

all

stall

mall

gall

squall

stall

appall

install

overall

rainfall

baseball

Tips

* When the /l/ phoneme follows a vowel, we know that often times the sound changes. This happens when the /ā/ comes before the /l/. The word all can be considered a word that contains heart parts due to the short a sound mimicking the short o.

* We typically see the grapheme al in the middle and all at the ending of words or syllables.

/am/ & /an/

am	ham	Pam	Sam	spam	yam	ram
	jam	exam	clam	cram	scam	slam
	tram	swam	bam	am	scram	gram
	program	sham	dam	amber	ambulance	ambition
an	and	can	ban	tan	pan	sand
	fan	plan	scan	ran	land	van
	man	span	than	antic	antler	ant
	Dan	Jan	nan	an	woman	anarch

Tips

* As explained in the /m/ and /n/ phoneme pages, when the phonemes /n/ and /m/ follow the short a, the sound becomes distorted. This is because the m and n graphemes are a nasal sound, which changes the sound that the a makes. The a produces a whiny sound instead of the short a. You can use the word list to help teach these sounds, but it is important to explain why this sound is produced. This is important for the /nk/ & /ng/ sounds on the next pages, too.

vowel + /ng/

ang

bang fang hang clang gang sang
tang chang twang pang dang rang

ing

sing ring ping ting swing wing
spring bing zing king cling thing
string wring fling sting anything something

ung

hung stung clung lung strung
swung flung sung dung rung

ong

long song strong wrong tong
pong prong along belong gong

vowel + /nk/

ank

blank Frank thank tank rank sank

spank crank prank flank clank bank

ink

sink pink rink link fink stink

twinkle shrink blink drink think brink

unk

dunk trunk skunk chunk clunk stunk

skunk plunk slunk spunk bunk flunk

onk

bonk honk donk zonk conk

SUFFIXES

-s or -es

The sound of the suffix will change based on the final letter of the base word.

/s/	cats books laughs cuffs cliffs roofs cakes myths bikes snakes mats thinks ships risks hikes rakes fists sloths bits sacks racks tacks masks tents
/z/	beans bees globes caves braids jeans queens days animals fingers crabs falls gloves doves rams bins hugs boys eagles bags dreams doors roads crows
/iz/	benches bosses buses matches glasses riches peaches touches sizes quizzes rushes teaches smashes watches fishes coaches breezes buzzes foxes mixes fixes prizes passes sketches

-s or -es

Tips

* The suffix s can make three sounds: /s/, /z/, or /ez/. This depends on the phoneme that the base word of the suffix ends with.

The -s makes the /s/ phoneme when there is a voiceless consonant that comes before the suffix. These letters are ones in which we do not feel a vibration in the throat when the sound is produced. These letters include p, t, c, k, q, f, h, s, and x. However, if a base word ends in s or x, the suffix will produce the /iz/ sound.

The -s suffix makes the /z/ phoneme when there is a voiced consonant or a vowel at the end of the base word. The voiced consonants included b, d, g, j, l, m, n, ng, r, z, th (voiced), v, w, y, and z. These sounds can be felt on the throat when the sound is produced.

The -es suffix makes the /iz/ phoneme when the noun ends in the following consonants: -s, -x, -z, -sh, -ch. The suffix that will be used is -es with these words. This will produce the /iz/ sound.

Sometimes the addition of a suffix can add a singular sound, but sometimes it makes the word gain a syllable. Talk through these words as you begin to create using the suffix.

-ed

The sound of the suffix will change based on the final letter of the base word.

/id/	wanted hunted frosted spotted lifted waited rated landed added faded needed weeded dated related posted roasted waded planted slanted handed trained rained braided created
/t/	jumped smacked stacked crashed washed fussed tripped matched popped baked picked mixed mapped dressed bluffed taxed talked walked dumped kicked sniffed fished tossed stopped
/d/	dobbed grabbed filled pulled trimmed buzzed yawned played spilled mowed chilled banged sailed hugged scanned banned timed saved called offered loved used enjoyed amazed

-s or -es

Tips

* The suffix s can make three sounds: /s/, /z/, or /ez/. This depends on the phoneme that the base word of the suffix ends with.

The -ed makes the /id/ phoneme when there is a -d or -t at the ending of the base word (land, want). When this happens, it is common that it will sound like there is an additional syllable added to the word (landed, wanted). Talk through this and be sure to have students know their base words prior to writing the word.

The -ed suffix makes the /d/ phoneme when there is a voiced consonant or a vowel at the end of the base word. The voiced consonants included b, d, g, j, l, m, n, ng, r, z, th (voiced), v, w, y, and z. These sounds can be felt on the throat when the sound is produced.

The -ed suffix makes the /t/ phoneme when there is a voiceless consonant before the -ed suffix. The voiceless consonants include p, k, f, ch, s, sh, and the (unvoiced). The sound can be felt on the throat when the sound is produced to check to see if it is a voiced or voiceless sound.

OVERVIEW

The Sound Mound manual is an extra resource to guide you in your teaching of Sound Mounds. This resource can be used in a variety of ways and will continually be updated for your own knowledge. Please reach out if you have any questions or concerns in regards to the manual or have any Sound Mound questions. My emails is theeppichclassroom@gmail.com.

CREDITS

All clipart and resources used to create the Sound Mounds are credited to those listed below.

